GG-O-588b
April 10, 1964

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG-O-00588a (GSA-FSS)
February 12, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. GG-O-588
February 13, 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# OPENER, LETTER, HAND, METAL

*This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.*

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 **Scope.** This specification covers metal letter openers for general office use.

1.2 **Classification.**

1.2.1 *Type.* Letter openers covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I.—Offset blade type.
Type II.—Straight or flat type.

## 2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

*Federal Specifications*:

PPP-B-566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665—Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

*Federal Standards*:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specificatoins and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington D. C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

*Military Specification*:

MIL-C-116—Preservation, Methods of.

*Military Standards*:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)



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## 3. REQUIREMENTS

**3.1 Material.** Material shall be steel, heat-treated or worked to a hardness of Rockwell C-45 to C-60 and treated to resist corrosion as specified in 3.1.2, or shall be corrosion resisting steel. (See 4.5.1.)

**3.1.1** *Thickness.* Thickness of metal for type I and type II openers shall be 0.075 inch ± 0.002 inch.

**3.1.2** *Finish.* Openers shall be nickel- or chromium-plated and smoothly polished.

**3.2 Length of openers.**

3.2.1 Length of type I opener shall be 8-13/16 inches ± 1/4-inch from tip to end of handle.

3.2.2 Length of type II opener shall be 9 inches ± 1/4-inch from tip to end of handle.

**3.3 Size of blades.**

3.3.1 Blade of type I opener shall be 5-1/2 inches ± 1/8 inch long from point of offset, and shall be beveled on both edges in a manner suitable for functional operation of the opener. Width of blade shall be 5/16 inch ± 1/16 inch throughout and tip of blade shall be ovally tapered to a point.

3.3.2 Blade of type II opener shall be 6 inches ± 1/8-inch long and shall be beveled on both edges in a manner suitable for functional operation of the opener. Width of blade shall be 5/16-inch ± 1/16-inch throughout and tip of blade shall be ovally tapered to a point.

3.4 Size of handles.

3.4.1 Handle of type I opener shall be 3 inches ± 1/8-inch long from point of offset to end of handle and 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide at the end of the handle, tapering to not less than 5/8-inch in width at point of offset, or shall be 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide for the entire length of the handle. The end of the handle shall be rounded. A 3/16-inch hole near the end or a slot 2-1/4 inches maximum longitude by 1/4-inch in width with ends of slot rounded shall be provided in the handle.

3.4.2 Handle of type II opener shall be 3 inches ± 1/8-inch long and 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide at the end of the handle, tapering to not less than 5/8-inch in width at the junction of the blade or shall be 3/4-inch ± 1/16-inch wide for the entire length of the handle. The end of the handle shall be rounded. A 3/16-inch hole near the end or a slot 2-1/4-inches maximum longtitude by 1/4-inch in width with ends of slot rounded shall be provided in the handle.

**3.5 Construction.**

3.5.1 Type I opener shall have blade offset approximately 7/16-inch from handle at a distance approximately 5-1/2-inches from tip of blade.

3.5.2 Type II opener shall lie flat on its surface through entire length.

**3.6 Workmanship.** The openers shall be free from burrs and other defects which affect their appearance or which may impair their serviceability.

## 4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

**4.1 Supplier's responsibility.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.



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4.2 Inspection lot. All openers offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection.

4.3 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.3.1 *Sampling for examination of preparation for delivery.* Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3. The sample unit shall be one fully packed shipping container.

4.3.2 *Sampling for examination of openers.* A random sample of openers shall be selected from each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The sample unit shall be one opener.

4.3.3 *Sampling for test.* A random sample of openers shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3. The sample unit shall be one opener.

4.4 Examination.

4.4.1 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* Samples selected in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be examined to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.2 *Examination of openers.* Sample openers, selected in accordance with 4.3.2, shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any opener in the sample containing one of more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent for minor defects.

4.4.3 *Test.* Sample openers, selected in accordance with 4.3.3 shall be subjected to the test described in 4.5. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective.

TABLE I.—*Classification of defects*

| Defects | Category | |
|---|---|---|
| | Major | Minor |
| Not type specified. | X | |
| Dimensions not as specified, within tolerance. | X | |
| Hole or slot not provided in handle. | X | |
| Construction not as specified. | X | |
| Workmanship: Any defects which— | | |
| Impair serviceability. | X | |
| Affect appearance. | | X |

4.5 Test.

4.5.1 *Corrosion test.* Sample openers shall be subjected to a 20-percent sodium-chloride solution spray test in accordance with method 811 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151 for a period of 2 hours. Evidence of corrosion will be considered as failure to meet the requirements of this specification.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The openers shall be packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, style II, type A or B, class a; PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional. Each box shall be waterproofed in accordance with MIL-C-116, method IC-2.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Twelve openers shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1 except that waterproofing of boxes shall not be required.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The openers shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's standard practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).



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5.2.1 *Level A.* The openers shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c, style RSC. Each box shall be waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Twelve packages of twelve openers each shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the boxes shall be type I, class 1, and waterproofing shall not be required. Sealing and closures, shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The openers shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.** (See 6.1.)

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Each box of 12 openers shall be marked on one end with the Federal Stock Number, Federal item identification, and the quantity contained therein.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

## 6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type required (see 1.2.1).

(*c*) Inspection responsibility if other than specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records when applicable (see 4.1).

(*d*) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.2 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 **Transportation data.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

*Rail*:

Tools, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

*Motor*:

Hand tools, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

DOD coordination has been waived.



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